

was unwilling to spend all of her money, and anyway, she didn't know what kind of classes to take or what sort of career she should prepare for. She started a savings account and added to it every payday. Soon she had a thousand dollars of her own. She was determined to never again know what it was like to have to make do with the clothes she already owned and never treat herself to something new, or to have to decline going to a restaurant or a movie with friends because she had no money in her pocket.

After two years, Nancy invited Beth to live with her and share expenses. Beth was ready to leave home, so, with her mother's blessing, she moved a few hours away to join her sister. She had grown interested in graphic arts by that time and found a good program near her new home.

She decided to use her savings to begin the semester and pay her share of the rent, and soon her account had dwindled. She found a part-time job on campus and quickly became absorbed in her studies. She attended church with Nancy and there made friends. After a year, Nancy got married, and Beth moved into another apartment with two young women she had met at church.

The new apartment was unfurnished, so the three went shopping. Beth used her credit card for her share of the purchases and hit her limit before she knew it. She accepted an offer for another credit card and then another.

Before the second year of schooling, Beth applied for and received student loans. Her part-time job was sufficient to pay rent, and she was able to pay the minimum amounts due on all three of her credit cards. She enjoyed being single and independent, and was able to charge new clothes and go out socially with friends and not feel that she had to deny herself. Once in a while she would be concerned at the high balances on her credit card statements, but as long as she was paying the minimum due, she put the worries out of her mind.

After she graduated, Beth found a job in her field and moved into her own apartment. She made enough in salary to afford a down payment on a new car. Her rent was higher, she now had car